STEADFAST MEN

Lesson 08 · The Empty Chair

Week 8. The empty chair

Participant worksheet

Steadfast Men
The way of Godly Men
Wes Hart

Read this week: Chapter 8, The empty chair.

One job: Finish this sentence: The chair at the end of my table was blank. Then say one thing it taught you.

The line

A steadfast man stops waiting, picks up the weight, goes first, and works for God's pay, not the room's.

Write it once. This week is not a recap of the four. This week is the chair. Part 2 starts here.

_____
_____

> **Ephesians 6:4 NIV**
> Fathers, do not exasperate your children; instead, bring them up in the training and instruction of the Lord.

Name it

Finish this sentence out loud tonight: The chair at the end of my table was blank.

_____

One thing it taught me:

_____
_____

Do this week

Write your father a letter you will not send. Tell him what you needed, what you did not get, and what you are grateful for, if anything. Keep it where you can find it. You will want it later in this course.

I wrote it on: _____

I kept it: _____

Tell a brother

Read him the sentence you finished, not the letter unless you want to. Let him answer with me too or I am sorry without either of you hurrying past it.

I told (name): _____ on (day): _____

He sat still: _____

Alone: still tell one man. Same week. Do not ask him to sit in the chair for you. Ask him to hear you.

Carry this

What sat in the chair was handed to you. What you do with the chair is yours.

Write it once.

_____

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Leader guide

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Before the room

Read this week: Chapter 8, The empty chair.

Aim: The father hole is real. Name the empty chair. Do not heal it all on this page.

One job: Finish this sentence: The chair at the end of my table was blank. Then say one thing it taught you.

Pitfall: Do not recap Part 1. Do not open next week's fruit. Do not open the Father who does not leave. Do not rush him to a cure. Do not make his dad a devil. Do not let the chair excuse this week's sin. Kind. Slow. Naming is the hour.

Time: about an hour. Church, small group, or a man alone.

A steadfast man stops waiting, picks up the weight, goes first, and works for God's pay, not the room's.

Say it. Do not unpack it. This week is the chair. Part 2 starts here.

> **Ephesians 6:4 NIV**
> Fathers, do not exasperate your children; instead, bring them up in the training and instruction of the Lord.

Open (2-3 min)

A kitchen table still has to eat. Three plates go down. One chair sits with nothing in front of it, or a man sits in it and the boy still cannot get to him. Years later a grown man stands in a doorway before he walks into his own full table. He knows why. He has not said it yet.

Say the four. Then stop. We tell the truth about what he inherited.

Hit

You are not healing him tonight. You are putting a name on a hole.

Paul named what belonged in that chair. Not a perfect man. A father. A voice a boy could get to. Training. Instruction. The Lord in the room, not only a paycheck. If that was not his house, he is not inventing a wound.

Some chairs never arrived. Some left. Some died and the plate still gets set. Some came home already gone. Some were a storm. Some were good and still left a gap shaped like the places that man could not reach. Every man in the room inherited something. Do not sand his to match yours.

The chair explains him. It does not excuse him. What sat in the chair was handed to him. What he does with the chair is his. Understanding that forever without changing anything is not progress. Naming is.

Do not preach next week's Father as tonight's cure. Do not open the fruit. Point at Chapter 8. Then shut up. Sit in the silence if you have to.

Table

Three. Wait longer than you want to.

1. Finish this out loud: The chair at the end of my table was blank.
2. What one thing did that chair teach you?
3. Can you say one true sentence about your father without a speech?

Young: stop waiting for a ghost to sit down before you become a man. Single: a future wife cannot sit in that chair. Married: he can father with a hole; he must not dump the chair into her lap. Hurt: cruel is not the same as empty, and both are real. Older: a door can close before the conversation; he can still say what needed saying. The job going well: hours will not father him, and they will not father his kids if all they get is the last ten minutes.

Run the closer

One chair. One sentence. One letter he keeps.

Name it. Finish this sentence out loud tonight: The chair at the end of my table was blank. Then say one thing it taught you.

Do this week. Write your father a letter you will not send. Tell him what you needed, what you did not get, and what you are grateful for, if anything. Keep it where you can find it. You will want it later in this course.

Tell a brother. Read him the sentence you finished, not the letter unless you want to, and let him answer with me too or I am sorry without either of you hurrying past it.

Carry this. What sat in the chair was handed to you. What you do with the chair is yours.

If a brother starts a cure, stop him. This chapter is the naming. He cannot sit in that chair for him. He can hear him.

Solo note

Read Chapter 8. Write the sentence the same day. Write the letter. Tell one man the sentence. Ask him not to fix it. Fine is a word a man uses when he does not want to say the chair is empty.

Do not open week 9. Do not open week 10.